



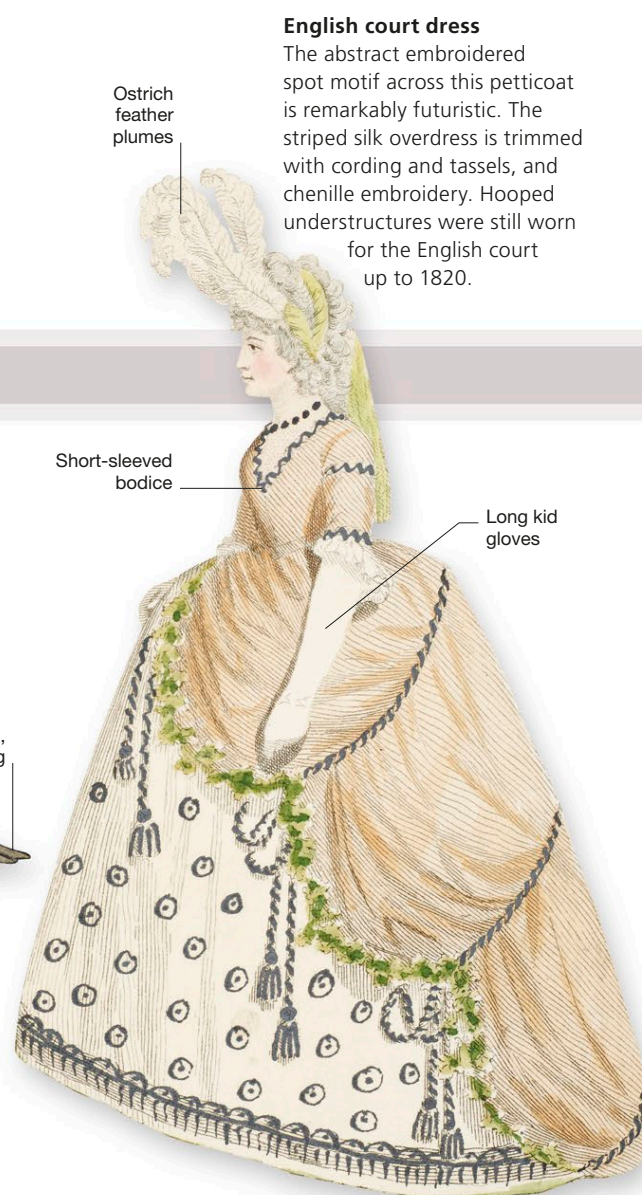
Flat pumps with pointed toe

Classic dress This is the essence of the neoclassical look. The flimsy muslin layers are indicated by the visible outline of a knee. The short Roman-style cloak has tasselled cord ties. Ribbon defines the bosom and high waistline.

1798



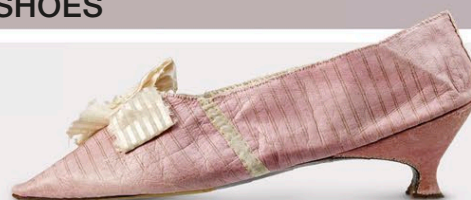
Evening ensemble The high waistline is clearly visible in this 1798 muslin dress. The full-length, sleeved overgarment is cut away and fastened under the bosom. Its dark colour could be accentuated with cut steel or Berlin ironwork jewellery.



English court dress

The abstract embroidered spot motif across this petticoat is remarkably futuristic. The striped silk overdress is trimmed with cording and tassels, and chenille embroidery. Hooped understructures were still worn for the English court up to 1820.

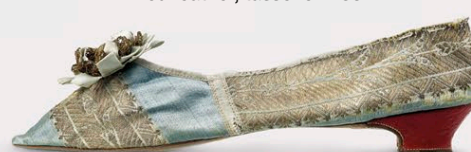
SHOES



Striped silk, Italian heel c.1790



Red leather, tassel c.1795



Woven silk, ribbon rosette c.1795

By the 1790s women wore slip-on "sandal shoes" with pointed toes. Heels were getting lower and disappeared by 1800. Italian heels were also all the rage. Pattens were still worn to protect shoes outdoors, especially over painted leather or brocaded silk shoes. Lighter pump-style slippers of kid leather, striped silk, and silk satin were worn for indoors.

Those who could afford to, had their shoes made to measure by their shoemaker. However, straights – shoes that were interchangeable, without a left or a right – were usual. Pink and yellow were popular dye colours, and there is a clear Eastern influence in shoes of the later 18th century that complements textiles such as the Indian cottons and Kashmir shawls of the period.